

INTRODUCTION TO BUSINESS & MANAGEMENT

Mock Examination · AY 2025–2026

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes · Total: 100 marks

Instructions: Answer ALL questions in Section A. Answer TWO questions from Section B. Answer ONE reflective essay in Section C. Write clearly and concisely.

SECTION A — Short Answer Questions (30 marks)

Answer ALL 10 questions. Each answer must be NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS. (3 marks each)

1. What term describes an organisational structure with many levels of hierarchy and a narrow span of control?

2. Which appraisal method collects feedback from a manager, peers, subordinates, and the employee themselves?

3. What is the name of the pricing strategy where a product is launched at a high price to target early adopters before gradually lowering the price?

4. In the BCG Matrix, what term is given to products with high market share in a low-growth market that generate steady cash for the business?

5. What is the term for a promotional model that describes the stages a customer moves through: Attention, Interest, Desire, and Action?

6. Which method of production involves making a unique, one-off product tailored to a specific customer order?

7. In Critical Path Analysis, what term refers to the amount of time an activity can be delayed without affecting the overall project completion date?

8. What type of distribution channel involves the producer selling directly to the end consumer with no intermediaries?

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9. According to McGregor, which theory assumes employees are naturally lazy, avoid responsibility, and must be closely supervised?
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10. What term describes the process of removing layers of management from an organisational hierarchy to create a flatter structure?
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SECTION B — Extended Response Questions (50 marks)

Answer TWO of the following FOUR questions. Each question is worth 25 marks.

Question B1

Zara is a global fashion retailer operating in over 90 countries. It is known for its fast-fashion model, launching new product lines every two weeks. The company relies on a centralised decision-making structure at its headquarters in Spain, but recently faced criticism that this slows its response to local market trends.

- (a) Explain the difference between centralisation and decentralisation. Using the information above, discuss ONE advantage and ONE disadvantage of Zara's centralised structure.

[10 marks]

- (b) Explain TWO differences between a mechanistic and an organic organisational structure. Suggest which structure would be more appropriate for a fast-fashion company like Zara and justify your answer.

[15 marks]

Question B2

GreenBite is a new plant-based food brand launching its first product — a range of vegan protein bars — in a competitive health food market. The founders must decide on their pricing strategy and how to distribute the product to consumers.

- (a) Explain penetration pricing and skimming pricing. Recommend which pricing strategy GreenBite should use for its product launch and justify your recommendation.

[10 marks]

- (b) Describe THREE distribution channels available to GreenBite. Discuss the factors the business should consider when choosing the most appropriate channel for its vegan protein bars.

[15 marks]

Question B3

TechBuild Ltd is a software development company that has just won a contract to build a new mobile application for a retail client. The project must be completed within 14 weeks. The project manager has identified the following activities:

Activity	Duration (weeks)	Preceding Activity
A — Requirements gathering	2	None
B — System design	3	A
C — Backend development	5	B
D — Frontend development	4	B
E — Integration & testing	3	C, D
F — Client review & handover	1	E

(a) Draw a network diagram for the project. Label each node with the EST (Earliest Start Time) and LFT (Latest Finish Time). Identify the critical path.

[15 marks]

(b) Calculate the float for activities C and D. Explain what float means and why it is useful for project managers.

[10 marks]

Question B4

FreshPress is a juice manufacturing company that produces three product lines: FreshPress Original (a cash cow), FreshPress Boost (a star), and FreshPress Kids (a question mark). The company is considering whether to invest further in FreshPress Kids or discontinue it.

(a) Explain the four categories of the BCG Matrix. Using the information above, analyse the current position of each FreshPress product within the matrix.

[12 marks]

(b) Discuss the concept of a balanced product portfolio. Recommend whether FreshPress should invest in, maintain, or discontinue FreshPress Kids. Justify your answer using the Product Life Cycle and BCG Matrix.

[13 marks]

SECTION C — Reflective Essay (20 marks)

Write ONE reflective essay of approximately 250 words. There is no single correct answer — you are assessed on the depth of your reflection and your ability to apply course concepts to a real business or professional context of your choice.

Choose ONE of the following prompts:

Option 1: Reflect on how an understanding of leadership styles and motivation theories could influence the way you would manage a team in your future career. Which theory do you find most convincing, and why?

Option 2: Reflect on how the marketing mix (4Ps or 4Cs) could be applied to a business idea or project you are personally interested in. How would you make decisions about product, price, place, and promotion?

Option 3: Reflect on the importance of organisational structure in a business you are familiar with (or one you would like to work in). How does structure affect communication, decision-making, and employee motivation?

— *End of Mock Examination* —

Good luck!